

Jai Hind

With the launch of Microsoft Office in Hindi, the company has fulfilled a long-standing demand of the Indian market. India is a country where only five per cent of the population can communicate and work using English. Yet, all the software available was essentially for this small minority.

The readership of Hindi newspapers far outnumbers readership of English newspapers, yet Hindi readers could not communicate well with the media companies because they lacked a good Hindi interface on their PCs. Since Microsoft Office (Hindi) allows use of English, as well as nine other Indian languages in the same system, union and state governments should instruct their departments and undertakings to switch over to this for effective e-governance.

Madhu Agrawal

Via e-mail



Mahesh Benkar

Cell 'n' accelerator

Firstly, my heartiest congratulations for three great issues in a row—December, January and February. Every issue was packed with cool stuff, including extra CDs, the Zero1 awards and of course, the Ice Age VCD. Now I am eagerly awaiting a full-fledged edition on cell phones. Hope you won't disappoint me.

Ashish Pawar

Via e-mail

I am studying to be a computer engineer, and I make it a point to go through all the PC and technology magazines available at the newsstand. But the Digit February issue was the best. Does it rock, or what! I found the reviews of motherboards, RAM chips and processors quite helpful.

When are you reviewing graphics accelerators, especially since they are now affordable? One more observation: The article on LiLo was brilliant, and it is a good beginning!

Avik Chakraborty

Via e-mail

Dear Madhu,

You could not have been more accurate in your assessment. Communicating in the peoples' language is the hallmark of any e-governance model. Both, state and union governments in India, have been using regional language software for some time now, so Microsoft's Hindi language tool is not groundbreaking. Yet, it is also true that Microsoft's Office suite is the most commonly used PC application. Your suggestion, in that sense, definitely holds merit.

digit

Dear Ashish and Avik,

First of all, thank you for those kind words. Of course we will review cellphones, Ashish. Since we cover the entire gamut of technology, we were bound to cover a lot other things too. But if you read our Bazaar section for the last six months or so, we have been reviewing cell phones regularly. This month, too, we have tested and reviewed the Handspring Treo 180 PDA phone and the Nokia 6600 camera phone (turn to Page 88 of this issue for more).

Nothing pleases us more than to hear that our readers liked Digit, and found it useful. We will definitely incorporate your suggestion in the forthcoming issues.

digit

Price, please!

I bought a branded PC last September, and it was also the day I bought Digit for the first time. I have not missed a single copy of the magazine ever since. Well, I just could not afford to. May I suggest something? Digit should include prices of major PC components such as RAM, motherboards, graphics cards, etc. It will be a great value-add for readers like me.

Abhishek Sood

Via e-mail

Dear Abhishek,

Your suggestion is priceless. At Digit, we have contemplated printing prices of components a lot of times, and which is why we have the A-list (found on page 86 and 87). Here, we list the prices and the contact information of components in two categories—Best Value and Best Performance. However, we are hampered by the fact that these prices fluctuate at regular intervals, usually within days. And because Digit is a monthly magazine, the prices at the time of printing may not be the same as when you receive the copy at home, or when you pick it up from the newsstand.

digit

Nahi CDsi baat

I was disappointed with the February 2004 issue. The CDs did not auto-play. I installed the Flash player, yet the CDs did not run, and all I got was a blank white screen. As a last resort, I went back to the basics—opened my Windows Explorer and right-clicked the CD drive to open. I got all the software I needed, but it was a boring experience, since I missed your design.

Upneet Shah

Via e-mail

Hello Upneet,

The reason your CDs did not run despite installing the Flash player from the CD is because some of the components are still missing on your PC. The best option, in this case, would be to download the Flash player directly from the Macromedia site. It is only a 480 KB plug-in, and should not take more than a minute to download. Once installed, please close your browser window, and start the CD interface again.

digit

digit READERPOLLS

Q. Would you buy a high-end graphics card?

I already own one!
3.2%

Yes - 5.7%

No - 3.9%

Only if the prices dropped
87.2%

Responses: 6480

Your vote counts

This month's question:

Have you bought a new PC or a laptop, or upgraded your system, after low prices following the mini-budget?

- ☐ Yes, I bought a PC
- ☐ Yes, I upgraded

- ☐ Yes, I bought a laptop
- ☐ None of the above

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote